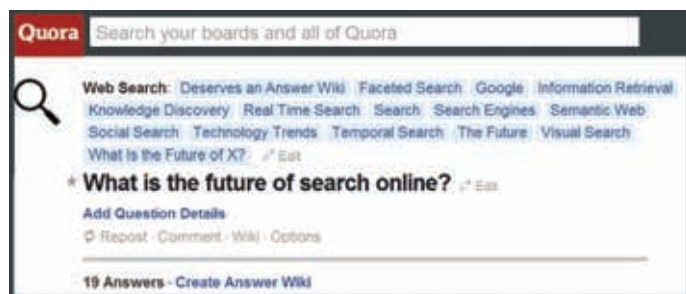


sense of belonging to a simple ego boost, the benefits are many. It's the same kind of desire that prompts people to share an interesting article or a funny video. We don't have any compunctions to stake a small claim (of discovery) over that content, so why won't we share our own original thought? Besides, geeks are smart and though not necessarily show-offs we like to be right, right? What better way than to unleash your knowledge online and be the guiding light to the hordes?

Now that you're probably convinced about the idea there might be another argument cropping up. "I don't have any knowledge to share!" you might cry. The truth is that as we go through life, the sum total of our existence definitely teaches each and every one of us a thing or two. On communities such as Quora, people can share their knowledge on any topic. From life lessons to astrophysics and everything in between. The site operates on a question-answer basis, and being initially invite only and completely non-anonymous keeps it from becoming another Yahoo! Answers. Even a question like "Did Celtic warriors ride into battle on bears?", gets well researched answers



Ask, answer, learn or simply browse - a knowledge junkie's dream.

and comments that explore the question's hidden connotations. Sites such as Squidoo and askville about all thrive on user contributed knowledge. Even wiseGEEK which is professionally curated, refines much of its content by way of comments left by enthusiastic geeks.

Last but not the least, let's not forget the ultimate destination of the knowledge junkie, that culture of cultures, the good old guardian of the old internet forums! Geeks with an unimaginably niche expertise descend on web forums that are equally niche. Take TDF for instance; there are few sources on the web that can give you better knowledge about your tech queries. Forums exist for all

sorts of subjects, ranging from photography to UFO sightings and more. <http://bit.ly/cultknow>

May I have your attention please

No matter how much anyone denies it, it's human nature to want attention. The amount and kind of attention one wants however differs from people to people. For instance, some, err, attention seekers on social networks are experts at photography and Photoshop effects (proof: image alongside). But geeks look for attention of a different kind. It's a bit of a higher pursuit, leaning towards intellectual appreciation rather than likes for putting up emotional quotes or pictures of puppies. So how do you go about acquiring fame, recognition and, in some cases notoriety online? Heck, there are several ways. The goal is to inspire reaction, and hence get attention.

The trend of late has been to start fake Twitter accounts or Twitter accounts that are self-confessed fake accounts of celebrities. Some of the more famous ones in India are @fakeiplplayer, @SatanBhagat, @jhunjhunwala, etc. Whether to go this

way is a question of choice of course. Humour is also important; after all who doesn't want a good laugh. Witty Twitterisms or Twitter wittisims are the currency of the day. Parodying pop culture seems to always work too.

There's fakingnews, flyyoufools, <http://onionnuttapam.com> and others. However if you want to go the serious route, start a blog or Twitter account and keep your posts consistently on a particular topic. You could eventually get recognition as an expert on a particular subject. Geeks, by nature, like to delve into a particular subject thoroughly. You could be an expert on GPUs, camera gear, or even hacking. Pretty soon you'll have a dedicated following.

Do it yourself

Perhaps the most common trait amongst geeks is that insatiable curiosity to discover new stuff. This includes finding out how everyday things around us



There's a difference between seeking attention, and being an exhibitionist

work. Many toys, and later gadgets such as phones, radios and TVs have faced their untimely demise at the hands of little geeks who tore them apart to find out what makes them tick. Chips, glue, malformed soldered alloy may look grotesque to people, compared to a gadget's sleek external body, but to a geek these things are the soul of the gadget. Individuals inclined to such pursuits move from tearing down stuff to actually building things and hence become part of the thriving DIY culture. DIYs gives practitioners a sense of achievement that comes from creating something tangible, that works and solves a problem. The culture spans not just electronic gadgets but also things like household fixes, appliances fixing etc. Some consider the culture to also include making changes to Open source software to suit their own needs. DIY is all about taking charge of technology around you and coming up with solutions. "I had this old laptop whose battery had failed and was on the brink of total shutdown. I didn't have much to lose if I couldn't put it back together again so I decided to open it up just to understand how it works. Pretty soon I was fixing

